

You will notice that the single physical device has two virtual Wi-Fi interfaces, each with its own SSID. This set-up is, hence, not totally transparent. Your device will need to explicitly connect to the access point or the relay.

The corresponding network configuration will contain the following code:

```
config interface 'lan'
    option ifname 'eth0'
    option type 'bridge'
    option proto 'static'
    option ipaddr '192.168.1.254'

config interface 'wan'
    option proto 'dhcp'

config 'interface' 'stabridge'
    option 'proto' 'relay'
    option 'network' 'lan wan'
    option ipaddr '192.168.1.253'
```

You will also need to disable the firewall.

A routed client

The second option is that the second Wi-Fi router establishes a separate network and routes traffic from

this network to the access point. The configuration file for wireless remains the same as for the relay client. The network configuration file will contain the following:

```
config interface 'lan'
    option ifname 'eth0'
    option type 'bridge'
    option proto 'static'
    option ipaddr '192.168.2.254'

config interface 'wan'
    option proto 'dhcp'
```

The IP address for the LAN will be outside the address range of the main router. The firewall is preconfigured to forward traffic from the LAN to the WAN.

OpenWRT is a Linux distribution. So, in principle, you should be able to add packages to your normal distribution and create a Wi-Fi extender on your normal laptop. But you would lose the convenience of NetworkManager. So you may not want to use it every day, but it is a fun thing to try out. **END** 

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The author has earned the right to do what interests him. You can find him online at <http://sethanil.com>, <http://sethanil.blogspot.com>, and reach him via email at anil@sethanil.com.

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